

Houston

The best of the best in the city — must-visit, unique, a rockstar in its own right. The first edition, in Michelin's second year in Texas.

6

Michelin stars — including the first barbecue joint ever starred

22

Bib Gourmands, the most of any Texas city

1977

Ninfa's — where the fajita was invented

765

places across twelve lists

Honor Roll 10

Cafés 54

Speakeasies 51

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Restaurants 152

Brunch 51

Off-beat 52

Bakeries 50

Dessert 50

Scene 51

Nightlife 52

Itineraries 1 · 3 · 5 days

Yellow

= you've been

★

Michelin star

Bib

Bib Gourmand

50 Best №1

bar ranking

TM50 Texas Monthly Top 50 BBQ

JBF 2026

James Beard finalist or semifinalist

closed

verify = check before you go

Resy

Tock

OpenTable

SevenRooms

where to book

Amex ✓

Resy/Tock credit applies (Platinum \$100/qtr, Gold \$50 twice a year)

JBF 2026

James Beard nominee

\$-\$\$\$\$

rough spend per person: under \$20 / \$20–60 / \$60–150 / \$150+

Romantic

Date night

Casual

occasion (editorial, by category and price)

Compiled by Tony Abraham against Yelp, Google, the Houston Chronicle, Houstonia, Texas Monthly, Eater Houston, OpenTable, Resy and Tock. Michelin marks reflect the 2025 Texas selection; James Beard marks the 2026 awards. Cover: downtown from the freeway at dusk, via Pexels.

Tony *Abraham*

Technology entrepreneur. New Yorker. A passionate home cook who learned that the best way to understand a dish is to try to recreate it the next morning.

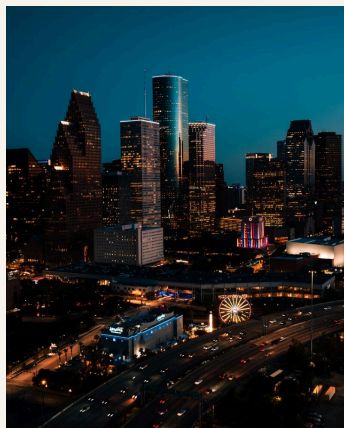
Honestly Speaking is written from a simple conviction: that the food itself — its taste, its texture, its quiet decisions — deserves a more careful kind of attention than it usually gets. The plate, not the room. The dish, not the hype.

Based in New York, with field notes from all around. *listede ville* / *Houston* is the tenth city guide — the most diverse food city in America, and the one the guides have covered least.

First edition, Fall/Winter 2026. Two of the second series done.

Honestly Speaking is also a restaurant review site — independent, unsponsored, one dish at a time. The city guides tell you where; the reviews tell you what to order and why. Read them at honestlyspeaking.xyz.

For feedback — a question, a correction, a place we missed, or just to say hi — write to hello@listede ville.com.



Honor Roll • 10 plates

Don't leave without these.

Ten places, ranked by nothing but the plate. A breakfast-taco window from 1977, a Viet-Cajun crawfish house, a barbecue joint with a Michelin star and a masa tasting menu with eight seats, all held to the same question: is this the best version of the thing in the city?

Houston is the most diverse city in America and its restaurants prove it every night — Bellaire's Vietnamese, Hillcroft's Indo-Pakistani, Third Ward's Creole, the Heights' smokehouses. These ten are where Michelin's Texas guide, the Beard committee, Texas Monthly and tens of thousands of Google reviews all point the same way, and where the food, not the valet, is the reason. Room, scene and price didn't count.

How to read it The marks are the same as everywhere else in the guide. The two lines under each name are new: why it made the roll, and what to put in front of you when you get there.

Tatemó

01

Spring Branch; Emmanuel Chavez's masa tasting

★ \$\$\$\$ Tock Amex ✓

Late night Group

Eight seats in a Spring Branch strip mall, one star, and a tasting menu built entirely on heirloom Mexican corn nixtamalized that morning — tortillas, tetelas, atoles, tamales. Emmanuel Chavez treats masa the way a French kitchen treats stock, and nothing else in Texas tastes like it.

Order The tasting — there is only one. The tortilla course with the season's salsa is the point; take the agave pairing.

March

02

Montrose; Felipe Riccio's Mediterranean tasting

★ \$\$\$\$ Tock Amex ✓

Late night Group

Goodnight Hospitality's tasting room changes its region twice a year — Andalusia, the Levant, the Maghreb — and cooks each with the precision of a starred kitchen and one of the best wine programs in the state. The one splurge on this roll that earns its price.

Order The full tasting with the wine pairing; ask the somm for the older bottles on the pairing's second half.

Street to Kitchen

03

East End

Bib JBF \$\$ Resy Amex ✓

Late night Group

Benchawan Painter won the Beard award for Best Chef: Texas cooking Thai food at Bangkok strength in a tiny East End room — no toning down, no substitutions, a Bib every year. The most important restaurant of the last five years in Houston.

Order The crispy pork belly, the green curry, the crab fried rice and the pad kra pao at full heat. Reserve; there are twenty seats.

Nancy's Hustle

04

EaDo

Bib \$\$ Resy Amex ✓

Late night Group

Jason Vaughan's EaDo bistro is the room Houston's cooks eat in on their nights off: the Hustle Bread with cultured butter, a tartare that's become a civic dish, natural wine and a Bib every year since the Guide arrived.

Order The Hustle Bread, the beef tartare, the mussels, and whatever pasta is on. Sit at the bar.

Truth BBQ

05

Heights; Leonard Botello

Bib TM50 \$\$ Walk-in

Late night Group

Leonard Botello's Heights smokehouse is Texas Monthly's top-five barbecue and Michelin's Bib for a reason: brisket with a black crust and a fat cap that gives, beef ribs the size of a forearm, and cakes made by his mother. The line is the price.

Order Brisket, moist, by the half-pound; a beef rib; the corn pudding; a slice of the tres leches or the carrot cake. In line by 10:30.

Blood Bros. BBQ

06

Bellaire; the Vietnamese-Texan smokehouse

Bib TM50 \$\$ Walk-in

Late night Group

Three friends from Alief put Vietnamese and Chinese flavors on a Texas smoker — brisket fried rice, Thai green curry boudin, gochujang beef ribs, char siu pork belly — and Texas Monthly, Michelin and the neighborhood all agreed it works. The most Houston restaurant in Houston.

Order Brisket fried rice, the char siu pork belly burnt ends, a Thai green curry boudin link, and whatever the Saturday special is. Sells out by mid-afternoon.

Crawfish & Noodles

07

Bellaire

JBF \$\$ Walk-in

Late night Group

Trong Nguyen's Bellaire room is where Viet-Cajun crawfish — boiled, then tossed in garlic butter and Vietnamese spice — went from a Houston secret to a national dish. A Beard semifinalist for Best Chef: Texas, repeatedly, from a strip mall.

Order Five pounds of crawfish, garlic butter, medium spice, in season (February to June); the salt-and-pepper blue crab and the garlic noodles otherwise.

Himalaya

08

Mahatma Gandhi District

JBF \$\$ Walk-in

Late night Group

Kaiser Lashkari cooks Pakistani and Indian food with a chef's precision on Hillcroft, and the Beard Foundation has named him a semifinalist for Best Chef: Texas more often than anyone in the city. The biryani is the standard; the specials are why the regulars come.

Order Chicken hara masala, the biryani, the karahi gosht, and the Hunter's beef sandwich if it's on. Ask what he cooked that morning.

Villa Arcos

09

East End; the breakfast taco line

\$ Walk-in

Late night

Group

A family taquería on Navigation Boulevard that has pressed flour tortillas every morning since 1977, filled with eggs, potato, chorizo and carne guisada at a price that hasn't caught up with the city. The breakfast taco every Houstonian measures the others against.

Order A carne guisada taco and a chorizo-and-egg taco, both on flour, salsa verde; a third if you're driving. Cash, and go before nine on weekends.

Nam Giao

10

Bellaire

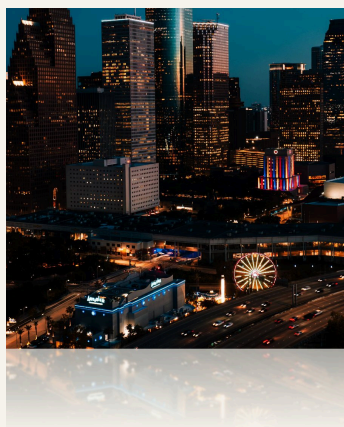
Bib \$ Walk-in

Late night

Group

Central Vietnamese cooking — the food of Hue — in a Bellaire strip mall, at prices that make its Bib the best value in the Texas guide: bánh bèo, bánh khọt, a bún bò Huế with real depth. The kind of restaurant Houston has by the hundred and nowhere else has at all.

Order Bánh bèo (the steamed rice cakes), the bánh khọt, and the bún bò Huế. Two people can eat for thirty dollars.



Cafés · 54 places

Cafés & all-day / chef's neighborhood spots

Montrose's Bibs, the Heights' wine bars, and the EaDo rooms where the city's cooks eat on their nights off.

The rooms you return to on a weeknight: Nancy's Hustle and Nobie's, Rosie Cannonball's wood oven, Theodore Rex, Squable and Coltivare in the Heights, and the Bibs that arrived in 2025 — Máximo, Annam, ChòpnBlòk, Da Gama.

Why these Picked for consistency and the neighborhood. Ten of Michelin's twenty-two Houston Bibs and most of its recommended rooms are on this list; the Ortega family's rooms are the 2026 Beard names.

Nancy's Hustle

EaDo; the Hustle Bread

Bib \$\$ Resy Amex ✓
Date night Casual

Nobie's

Montrose

Bib \$\$ Resy Amex ✓
Date night Casual

Rosie Cannonball

Montrose; wood-fired

Bib \$\$\$ Resy Amex ✓
Date night Casual

Theodore Rex

Warehouse District; Justin Yu

Bib \$\$\$ Resy Amex ✓
Date night Casual

Street to Kitchen

East End; Benchawan Painter's Thai

Bib JBF \$\$ Resy Amex ✓
Date night Casual

Da Gama Canteen

Heights; Indian-Portuguese

Bib \$\$ Resy Amex ✓
Date night Casual

Máximo

Museum District; Mexican

Bib \$\$\$ Resy Amex ✓
Date night Casual

Annam

Autry Park; Vietnamese

Bib new \$\$ Resy Amex ✓
Date night Casual

ChòpnBlòk

Montrose; West African

Bib new \$\$ Resy Amex ✓
Date night Casual

Belly of the Beast

Spring; Thomas Bille

Bib \$\$\$ Resy Amex ✓
Date night Casual

Bar Bludorn

Montrose

MR new \$\$\$ Resy Amex ✓
Date night Casual

Agnes and Sherman

Heights

MR new \$\$\$ Resy Amex ✓
Date night Casual

Late August

Museum District; Chris Williams

MR \$\$\$ Resy Amex ✓
Date night Casual

Josephine's

Montrose; Gulf Coast

MR new \$\$\$ Resy Amex ✓
Date night Casual

Perseid

Hotel Saint Augustine

MR new \$\$\$ Resy Amex ✓
Date night Casual

Candente

Montrose; Tex-Mex

MR \$\$ Resy Amex ✓
Date night Casual

Baso

Heights; Basque

MR \$\$\$ Resy Amex ✓
Date night Casual

Squable

Heights

\$\$\$ Resy Amex ✓
Date night Casual

Coltivare

Heights; the garden

\$\$\$ Walk-in

Date night Casual

Better Luck Tomorrow

Heights; Yu and Bobby Heugel

\$\$ Walk-in

Date night Casual

Anvil Bar & Refuge

Montrose

\$\$ Walk-in

Date night Casual

Riel

Montrose; Ryan Lachaine

\$\$\$ Resy Amex ✓

Date night Casual

Tiny Champions

EaDo; pizza and natural wine

\$\$ Resy Amex ✓

Date night Casual

The Marigold Club

Montrose

MR new \$\$\$ Resy Amex ✓

Date night Casual

March

Montrose; the tasting

★ \$\$\$\$ Tock Amex ✓

Date night Casual

Hugo's

Montrose; Hugo Ortega

JBF 2026 semifinalist (Outstanding Restaurateur)

\$\$\$ OpenTable

Date night Casual

Xochi

Downtown; Oaxacan

JBF \$\$\$ OpenTable

Date night Casual

Urbe

Uptown; Mexican street food

\$\$ OpenTable

Date night Casual

Caracol

Uptown; Mexican coastal

\$\$\$ OpenTable

Date night Casual

Backstreet Café

River Oaks; since 1983

\$\$\$ OpenTable

Date night Casual

Ninfa's on Navigation

East End; the original fajita

\$\$ OpenTable

Date night Casual

Mala Sichuan Bistro

Montrose / Chinatown

Bib \$\$\$ Walk-in

Date night Casual

Nam Giao

Bellaire; Hue-style Vietnamese

Bib \$ Walk-in

Casual

Crawfish & Noodles

Bellaire; Trong Nguyen

JBF \$\$ Walk-in

Date night Casual

Himalaya

Mahatma Gandhi District; Kaiser Lashkari

JBF \$\$ Walk-in

Date night Casual

Lucille's

Museum District; Chris Williams

JBF \$\$\$ OpenTable

Date night Casual

Bludorn

Montrose; Aaron Bludorn

MR \$\$\$\$ Resy Amex ✓

Date night Casual

Navy Blue

Rice Village; Bludorn's seafood

\$\$\$ Resy Amex ✓

Date night Casual

Georgia James

Regent Square; Chris Shepherd's steaks

\$\$\$ Resy Amex ✓

Date night Casual

Wild Oats

Houston Farmers Market; Nick Fine

\$\$ Resy Amex ✓

Date night Casual

Underbelly Burger

Houston Farmers Market

\$ Walk-in

Casual

Musaafer

Galleria; Indian tasting

★ \$\$\$\$ Resy Amex ✓

Date night Casual

Le Jardinier

MFAH; the museum

★ \$\$\$\$ Resy Amex ✓

Date night Casual

Tatemó

Spring Branch; masa tasting

★ \$\$\$\$ Tock Amex ✓

Date night Casual

BCN Taste & Tradition

Montrose; Spanish

★ \$\$\$\$ Resy Amex ✓

Date night Casual

MAD

River Oaks District; Spanish scene

\$\$\$ OpenTable

Date night Casual

Ostia

Montrose; Travis McShane

\$\$\$ Resy Amex ✓

Date night Casual

Indianola

EaDo

\$\$ Resy Amex ✓

Date night Casual

Vibrant

Montrose; the healthy one

\$\$ Resy Amex ✓

Date night Casual

Bar Louie?

closed

UBPreserv

closed

One Fifth

closed

Underbelly

the original

closed

Oxheart

closed



Speakeasies · 51 places

Speakeasies & hidden bars

Upstairs from a mezcaleria, behind a blue door since 1976, under a neon sparrow. Ranked, loosely, by the drink.

Houston hides its best bars upstairs (Tongue-Cut Sparrow, Bad News), behind unmarked doors (Marfireless since 1976) and in old buildings by Market Square (La Carafe, Warren's).

Why these Ranked by the drink. Anvil is the bar that taught the city to drink cocktails; Julep and Better Luck Tomorrow are its descendants. The ice houses are on because they're the real Houston bar.

Anvil Bar & Refuge

Montrose; Bobby Heugel, the 100 list

JBF \$\$ Walk-in
Date night Late night

Tongue-Cut Sparrow

Downtown; upstairs from the Pastry War, the rules

\$\$ Walk-in
Date night Late night

The Pastry War

Downtown; mezcaleria

\$\$ Walk-in
Date night Late night

Better Luck Tomorrow

Heights

\$\$ Walk-in
Date night Late night

Julep

Washington Ave; Alba Huerta

JBF \$\$ Walk-in
Date night Late night

Refuge?

Montrose

verify \$\$ Walk-in
Date night Late night

Squable bar

Heights

\$\$\$ Resy Amex ✓
Date night Late night

Bad News Bar

Downtown; upstairs, the balcony

\$\$ Walk-in
Date night Late night

Rosemont?

wine bar

verify \$\$ Walk-in
Date night Late night

Lei Low

Heights; tiki

\$\$ Walk-in
Date night Late night

Sidecar Tapas & Bar?

verify \$\$ Walk-in
Date night Late night

Nightingale Room

Downtown; the piano

\$\$ Walk-in
Date night Late night

Little Dipper

Downtown; the dive with good drinks

\$ Walk-in
Date night Late night

Trigger Happy?

verify \$ Walk-in
Date night Late night

La Carafe

Market Square; candles, the oldest bar, cash

\$ Walk-in
Date night Late night

Warren's Inn

Market Square; the stiff pour

\$ Walk-in
Date night Late night

Notsuoh

Downtown; the art bar

\$ Walk-in
Date night Late night

Moving Sidewalk

Downtown

\$\$ Walk-in
Date night Late night

Reserve 101

Downtown; whiskey

\$\$ Walk-in
Date night Late night

Bar Blutorn

Montrose; the bar side

MR \$\$\$ Resy Amex ✓
Date night Late night

Marfireless

River Oaks; the blue door, since 1976

\$ **\$** [Walk-in](#)

[Date night](#) [Late night](#)

Poison Girl

Montrose; the pinball, the bourbon

\$ [Walk-in](#)

[Date night](#) [Late night](#)

Grand Prize Bar

Montrose; two floors

\$ [Walk-in](#)

[Date night](#) [Late night](#)

Mongoose versus Cobra

Midtown; beer, the mezzanine

\$ **\$** [Walk-in](#)

[Date night](#) [Late night](#)

The Toasted Coconut

Heights; tiki

\$ **\$** [Walk-in](#)

[Date night](#) [Late night](#)

Eight Row Flint

Heights; agave and cider

\$ **\$** [Walk-in](#)

[Date night](#) [Late night](#)

Present Company

Montrose; the courtyard

\$ **\$** [Walk-in](#)

[Date night](#) [Late night](#)

Winnie's

Montrose; Cajun-Vietnamese bar food

\$ **\$** [Walk-in](#)

[Date night](#) [Late night](#)

Pearl Bar

Washington Ave

\$ [Walk-in](#)

[Date night](#) [Late night](#)

Two Headed Dog

Midtown; the Hungarian bar

\$ [Walk-in](#)

[Date night](#) [Late night](#)

Bar Boheme

Montrose; the patio, the pizza

\$ **\$** [Walk-in](#)

[Date night](#) [Late night](#)

West Alabama Ice House

Montrose; since 1928

\$ [Walk-in](#)

[Date night](#) [Late night](#)

Alice's Tall Texan

Heights; goblets of Lone Star

\$ [Walk-in](#)

[Date night](#) [Late night](#)

Big Star Bar

Heights; the yard

\$ [Walk-in](#)

[Date night](#) [Late night](#)

D&T Drive Inn

Heights; the ice house

\$ [Walk-in](#)

[Date night](#) [Late night](#)

Rudyard's

Montrose; British pub, since 1978

\$ [Walk-in](#)

[Date night](#) [Late night](#)

Catbirds

Montrose

\$ [Walk-in](#)

[Date night](#) [Late night](#)

Lola's Depot

Montrose; the dive

\$ [Walk-in](#)

[Date night](#) [Late night](#)

The Continental Club

Midtown; the Houston branch

\$ [Walk-in](#)

[Date night](#) [Late night](#)

Shoeshine Charley's Big Top Lounge

Midtown; next to the Continental

\$ [Walk-in](#)

[Date night](#) [Late night](#)

Cottonwood

Garden Oaks; the yard

\$ **\$** [Walk-in](#)

[Date night](#) [Late night](#)

Kirby Ice House

Upper Kirby; the megayard

\$ [Walk-in](#)

[Date night](#) [Late night](#)

Axelrad

Midtown; hammocks and pizza

\$ [Walk-in](#)

[Date night](#) [Late night](#)

~~The Cottonmouth Club?~~

closed

Miss Carousel

closed

~~The Hay Merchant~~

closed

OKRA Charity Saloon

Downtown; you vote with your drink

\$ [Walk-in](#)

[Date night](#) [Late night](#)

Wooster's Garden

Midtown

\$ **\$** [Walk-in](#)

[Date night](#) [Late night](#)

Bar 5015?

Almeda; whiskey bar

verify **\$** **\$** [Walk-in](#)

[Date night](#) [Late night](#)

Bandista

Downtown; Tex-Mex cocktails

\$ **\$** [Walk-in](#)

[Date night](#) [Late night](#)

Dean's

Downtown; the old clothing store

\$ [Walk-in](#)

[Date night](#) [Late night](#)



Rooftops · 51 places

Rooftop bars

A flat city with big skies: the hotel roofs, then the ice houses, beer gardens and yards that do the same job at ground level.

Houston is flat and the roofs are hotel bars — Z on 23, the Post's Skylawn — but the outdoor culture is the ice house and the beer garden: West Alabama since 1928, Saint Arnold's yard, Axelrad's hammocks.

Why these Chosen for the air and the view. The breweries are on because Saint Arnold started Texas craft beer and the gardens are where the city drinks outdoors.

Z on 23

Le Méridien; downtown skyline

\$\$ Walk-in

Date night Group

Rooftop Cinema Club

Uptown; movies over the Galleria

\$\$ Walk-in

Date night Group

Bisou

River Oaks District; the terrace

\$\$\$ SevenRooms

Date night Group

High & Dry

Midtown; rum on the roof

\$\$ Walk-in

Date night Group

Wooster's Garden

Midtown

\$\$ Walk-in

Date night Group

Proof Rooftop Lounge

Midtown

\$\$ Walk-in

Date night Group

The Rustic

Downtown; the yard, live music

\$\$ Walk-in

Date night Group

Present Company

Montrose

\$\$ Walk-in

Date night Group

Bar Boheme patio

Montrose

\$\$ Walk-in

Date night Group

Axelrad beer garden

Midtown

\$ Walk-in

Date night Group

Kirby Ice House

Upper Kirby / Memorial

\$ Walk-in

Date night Group

West Alabama Ice House

Montrose

\$ Walk-in

Date night Group

Cottonwood

Garden Oaks

\$\$ Walk-in

Date night Group

Big Star Bar yard

Heights

\$ Walk-in

Date night Group

Eureka Heights Brewing

Heights

\$ Walk-in

Date night Group

Saint Arnold Beer Garden

Near Northside; the first craft brewery in Texas

\$ Walk-in

Date night Group

8th Wonder Brewery

EaDo; the Beatles statues

\$ Walk-in

Date night Group

Buffalo Bayou Brewing

Sawyer Yards; the roof deck

\$\$ Walk-in

Date night Group

Karbach Brewing

Spring Branch; the biergarten

\$ Walk-in

Date night Group

True Anomaly

EaDo

\$ Walk-in

Date night Group

Holler Brewing

Sawyer Yards

\$ Walk-in

Date night Group

Platypus Brewing

Timbergrove; Australian

\$ Walk-in

Date night Group

Great Heights Brewing

\$ Walk-in

Date night Group

Urban South HTX

Sawyer Yards

\$ Walk-in

Date night Group

Sawyer Park?

Sawyer Yards; the sports yard

\$\$ Walk-in

Date night Group

Bayou City Bar?

verify \$\$ Walk-in

Date night Group

The Emerald?

verify \$\$ Walk-in

Date night Group

Post Houston rooftop

Skylawn; the old post office, the view

\$ Walk-in

Date night Group

Eight Row Flint patio

Heights

\$\$ Walk-in

Date night Group

Coltivare garden

Heights

\$\$\$ Walk-in

Date night Group

Backstreet Café patio

River Oaks

\$\$\$ OpenTable

Date night Group

Hugo's balcony?

Montrose

\$\$\$ OpenTable

Date night Group

Brasserie 19 patio

River Oaks; the rosé

\$\$\$ OpenTable

Date night Group

La Colombe d'Or patio

Montrose

\$\$\$\$ OpenTable

Date night Group

Ouzo Bay patio

River Oaks District

\$\$\$ OpenTable

Date night Group

Rainbow Lodge

Heights; the log cabin on the bayou

\$\$\$ OpenTable

Date night Group

Marquis II?

closed

Buffalo Bayou Park Cistern

the walk, then a drink

\$ Walk-in

Date night Group

Discovery Green

Downtown; the Grove's patio

\$\$ OpenTable

Date night Group

Hermann Park's Pinewood Café?

\$ Walk-in

Date night Group

Lawn at White Oak Music Hall

Near Northside; shows on the hill

\$\$ Walk-in

Date night Group

Truck Yard

EaDo; the Ferris wheel

\$ Walk-in

Date night Group

The Dogwood

Midtown; the yard

\$ Walk-in

Date night Group

Pitch 25

EaDo; the sports yard

\$ Walk-in

Date night Group

Little Woodrow's

multiple; the yard

\$ Walk-in

Date night Group

Tin Roof?

Downtown

verify \$ Walk-in

Date night Group

Bar 5015 patio

Almeda

verify \$\$ Walk-in

Date night Group

Ballroom at Tanglewood?

closed

Neon Boots?

Northwest; the country dance yard

\$ Walk-in

Date night Group

Saint Arnold's rooftop?

the second-floor deck

\$ Walk-in

Date night Group

Third Coast

Texas Medical Center; the sixth-floor view

\$\$\$ OpenTable

Date night Group



Bars · 101 places

Bars

Anvil's 100 list, Julep's Southern drinks, La Carafe's candles, and the ice houses since 1928.

A serious cocktail city since Anvil in 2009 — Bobby Heugel and Alba Huerta are Beard nominees — with ice houses, wine bars, blues rooms and a country dancehall.

Why these Recognized first, then institutions, then the neighborhoods. Montrose's gay bars are on for history; the breweries for Saint Arnold's lineage.

Anvil Bar & Refuge

Montrose

JBF \$\$ Walk-in
Romantic Date night

Julep

Washington Ave

JBF \$\$ Walk-in
Romantic Date night

Tongue-Cut Sparrow

Downtown

\$\$ Walk-in
Romantic Date night

The Pastry War

Downtown

\$\$ Walk-in
Romantic Date night

Better Luck Tomorrow

Heights

\$\$ Walk-in
Romantic Date night

Squable

Heights

\$\$\$ Resy Amex ✓
Romantic Date night

Bar Bludorn

Montrose

MR \$\$\$ Resy Amex ✓
Romantic Date night

Bad News Bar

Downtown

\$\$ Walk-in
Romantic Date night

Lei Low

Heights

\$\$ Walk-in
Romantic Date night

The Toasted Coconut

Heights

\$\$ Walk-in
Date night Late night

Eight Row Flint

Heights

\$\$ Walk-in
Date night Late night

Present Company

Montrose

\$\$ Walk-in
Romantic Date night

Nightingale Room

Downtown

\$\$ Walk-in
Romantic Date night

Little Dipper

Downtown

\$ Walk-in
Late night

Moving Sidewalk

Downtown

\$\$ Walk-in
Date night Late night

Reserve 101

Downtown

\$\$ Walk-in
Romantic Date night

La Carafe

Market Square; since 1847 building

\$ Walk-in
Romantic Date night

Warren's Inn

Market Square

\$ Walk-in
Late night

Notsuoh

Downtown

\$ Walk-in
Late night

OKRA Charity Saloon

Downtown

\$ Walk-in
Late night

Dean's

Downtown

\$ Walk-in
Late night

Bandista

Downtown

\$ **\$** Walk-in

Date night Late night

Marfireless

River Oaks

\$ **\$** Walk-in

Romantic Date night

Poison Girl

Montrose

\$ Walk-in

Late night

Grand Prize Bar

Montrose

\$ Walk-in

Late night

Rudyard's

Montrose

\$ Walk-in

Late night

Catbirds

Montrose

\$ Walk-in

Late night

Lola's Depot

Montrose

\$ Walk-in

Late night

West Alabama Ice House

Montrose

\$ Walk-in

Group Casual

Bar Boheme

Montrose

\$ **\$** Walk-in

Date night Late night

Winnie's

Montrose

\$ **\$** Walk-in

Date night Late night

JR's Bar & Grill

Montrose; the gay strip since 1979

\$ Walk-in

Late night

Eagle Houston

Montrose

\$ Walk-in

Late night

Ripcord

Montrose

\$ Walk-in

Late night

Pearl Bar

Washington Ave; the lesbian bar

\$ Walk-in

Late night

Mongoose versus Cobra

Midtown

\$ **\$** Walk-in

Date night Late night

Two Headed Dog

Midtown

\$ Walk-in

Late night

Wooster's Garden

Midtown

\$ **\$** Walk-in

Group Casual

Axelrad

Midtown

\$ Walk-in

Group Casual

The Continental Club

Midtown

\$ Walk-in

Group Late night

Shoeshine Charley's Big Top Lounge

Midtown

\$ Walk-in

Group Late night

Cuchara

Montrose; the mezcal list

\$ **\$** OpenTable

Romantic Date night

Camerata

Montrose; wine bar

\$ **\$** Walk-in

Romantic Date night

13 Celsius

Midtown; wine

\$ **\$** Walk-in

Romantic Date night

Rosemont?

verify **\$** **\$** Walk-in

Date night Late night

Vinology

Rice Village

\$ **\$** Walk-in

Romantic Date night

Bar 5015

Alameda

verify **\$** **\$** Walk-in

Date night Late night

Alice's Tall Texan

Heights

\$ Walk-in

Group Casual

Big Star Bar

Heights

\$ Walk-in

Group Casual

D&T Drive Inn

Heights

\$ Walk-in

Group Casual

Cottonwood

Garden Oaks

\$ **\$** Walk-in

Group Casual

Petrol Station

Garden Oaks; the burger, the beer

\$ **\$** Walk-in

Group Casual

Kirby Ice House

Upper Kirby

\$ Walk-in

Group Casual

The Ginger Man

Rice Village; the beer hall

\$ Walk-in

Group Casual

Little Woodrow's

Rice Village / multiple

\$ Walk-in
Group Casual

Hans' Bier Haus

Rice Village

\$ Walk-in
Group Casual

Valhalla

Rice University; graduate students' bar, \$2 beer

\$ Walk-in
Group Casual

Under the Volcano

Rice Village; the frozen screwdriver

\$ Walk-in
Late night

Bobcat Teddy's Ice House

Heights

\$ Walk-in
Group Casual

Onion Creek

Heights; the patio

\$ Walk-in
Group Casual

Saint Arnold Beer Garden

\$ Walk-in
Group Casual

8th Wonder Brewery

EaDo

\$ Walk-in
Group Casual

Buffalo Bayou Brewing

Sawyer Yards

\$\$ Walk-in
Group Casual

Eureka Heights Brewing

\$ Walk-in
Group Casual

Karbach Brewing

\$ Walk-in
Group Casual

True Anomaly

EaDo

\$ Walk-in
Late night

Holler Brewing

\$ Walk-in
Group Casual

Platypus Brewing

\$ Walk-in
Group Casual

Great Heights Brewing

\$ Walk-in
Group Casual

Truck Yard

EaDo

\$ Walk-in
Group Casual

Pitch 25

EaDo

\$ Walk-in
Group Casual

Neil's Bahr

EaDo; the arcade bar

\$ Walk-in
Late night

Moon Tower Inn

East End; the hot dogs, the beer

\$ Walk-in
Group Casual

Voodoo Queen

East End; the daiquiris

\$ Walk-in
Late night

The Rustic

Downtown

\$\$ Walk-in
Date night Late night

Z on 23

Le Méridien

\$\$ Walk-in
Romantic Date night

High & Dry

Midtown

\$\$ Walk-in
Date night Late night

Proof Rooftop Lounge

Midtown

\$\$ Walk-in
Date night Late night

Howl at the Moon

Downtown; dueling pianos

\$\$ Walk-in
Group Late night

Dirt Bar

Downtown; the rock dive

\$ Walk-in
Late night

Rebels Honky Tonk

Downtown / Washington

\$ Walk-in
Group Late night

Neon Boots

Northwest; country dancehall

\$ Walk-in
Group Late night

Blanco's?

closed

Goode's Armadillo Palace

Kirby; the armadillo, the music

\$\$ Walk-in
Group Late night

McGonigel's Mucky Duck

Upper Kirby; folk and Irish

\$\$ Walk-in
Group Late night

The Big Easy Social & Pleasure Club

Upper Kirby; blues, since 1994

\$ Walk-in
Group Late night

Sambuca

Downtown; jazz and dinner

\$\$\$ OpenTable
Group Late night

Cezanne

Montrose; the jazz room above Black Lab

\$ **\$** Walk-in

Group Late night

Black Labrador

Montrose; the pub

\$ Walk-in

Late night

The Flat

Montrose; the DJ lounge

\$ Walk-in

Late night

Boondocks

Montrose

\$ Walk-in

Late night

Numbers

Montrose; since 1978, the new wave

\$ Walk-in

Group Late night

Rich's

Midtown; the dance floor

\$ **\$** Walk-in

Group Late night

Barbarella

Midtown; 80s nights

\$ Walk-in

Group Late night

The Secret Group

EaDo; comedy and beer

\$ Walk-in

Late night

Lucky's Pub

EaDo; the soccer bar

\$ Walk-in

Late night

~~The Hay Merchant~~

closed

~~Miss Carousel~~

closed

~~Marquis H~~

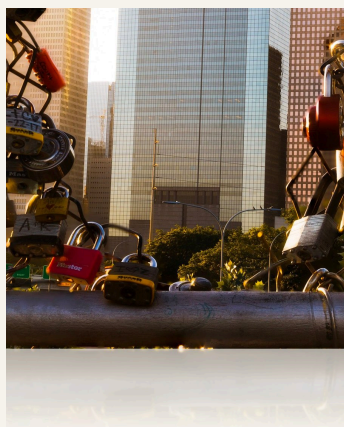
closed

~~Bar Louie~~

closed

~~Cottonmouth Club~~

closed



Coffee · 50 places

Coffee shops

Vietnamese coffee at every bánh mì counter, the Blacksmith breakfast, and the roasters that grew up in the Heights.

Vietnamese coffee is the city's native cup — cà phê sữa đá at every Bellaire counter — and the third-wave rooms grew up in the Heights and Montrose: Boomtown, Greenway, Blacksmith, Siphon.

Why these Selected for the cup and the room. Blacksmith's Vietnamese steak and eggs is the breakfast; the bakery cafés — Common Bond, Koffeteria, Morningstar — are the best mornings.

Blacksmith

Montrose; the Vietnamese steak and eggs

\$ \$ Walk-in

Sweets Brunch

Boomtown Coffee

Heights / multiple; the roaster

\$ Walk-in

Sweets Brunch

Greenway Coffee

Downtown tunnels / Montrose

\$ Walk-in

Sweets Brunch

Morningstar

Heights; David Buehrer's donuts

\$ Walk-in

Sweets Brunch

Siphon Coffee

Montrose

\$ Walk-in

Sweets Brunch

Catalina Coffee

Washington Ave

\$ Walk-in

Sweets Brunch

Southside Espresso

Montrose; wine at night

\$ Walk-in

Sweets Brunch

Agora

Montrose; the Greek café, 2am

\$ Walk-in

Sweets Brunch

Antidote

Heights; the vintage room

\$ Walk-in

Sweets Brunch

Campesino Coffee House

Montrose / Heights; Latin

\$ Walk-in

Sweets Brunch

Tenfold Coffee

Heights

\$ Walk-in

Sweets Brunch

Cafeza

Near Northside; the cafecito

\$ Walk-in

Sweets Brunch

Throughgood Coffee

Northside / Rice Village

\$ Walk-in

Sweets Brunch

Retrospect Coffee Bar

Midtown; the gas station

\$ Walk-in

Sweets Brunch

Prelude Coffee & Tea

Downtown; the tunnels

\$ Walk-in

Sweets Brunch

Minuti Coffee

Downtown / multiple; Italian

\$ Walk-in

Sweets Brunch

Amaya Roasting

Heights / multiple

\$ Walk-in

Sweets Brunch

Black Hole Coffee House

Montrose; the study room

\$ Walk-in

Sweets Brunch

Brasil

Montrose; the patio, since 1992

\$ **\$** [Walk-in](#)

[Sweets](#) [Brunch](#)

Common Bond

Montrose / multiple; the bakery café

\$ **\$** [Walk-in](#)

[Sweets](#) [Brunch](#)

Koffeteria

EaDo; the pastries

\$ **\$** [Walk-in](#)

[Sweets](#) [Brunch](#)

Tout Suite

EaDo

\$ **\$** [Walk-in](#)

[Sweets](#) [Brunch](#)

Cherry Coffee?

Midtown

verify **\$** [Walk-in](#)

[Sweets](#) [Brunch](#)

Fellini Caffè

Rice Village; Italian, the granita

\$ [Walk-in](#)

[Sweets](#) [Brunch](#)

Sweet Paris

Rice Village; crêpes

\$ **\$** [Walk-in](#)

[Sweets](#) [Brunch](#)

Inversion Coffee

Montrose; the art space

\$ [Walk-in](#)

[Sweets](#) [Brunch](#)

Empire Café

Montrose; Monday half-price cake

\$ **\$** [Walk-in](#)

[Sweets](#) [Brunch](#)

Bungalow Heights?

\$ **\$** [Walk-in](#)

[Sweets](#) [Brunch](#)

Day 6 Coffee Roasters

Sugar Land

\$ [Walk-in](#)

[Sweets](#) [Brunch](#)

Paper Co. Café

Pearland?

verify **\$** [Walk-in](#)

[Sweets](#) [Brunch](#)

Lee's Fried Chicken & Donuts

Heights; the drive-through

\$ [Walk-in](#)

[Sweets](#) [Brunch](#)

Shipley Do-Nuts

multiple; the Houston chain since 1936

\$ [Walk-in](#)

[Sweets](#) [Brunch](#)

Christy's Donuts

Montrose; since 1980

\$ [Walk-in](#)

[Sweets](#) [Brunch](#)

The Original Hungry's?

verify **\$** **\$** [Walk-in](#)

[Sweets](#) [Brunch](#)

Ipanema Café

verify **\$** [Walk-in](#)

[Sweets](#) [Brunch](#)

Doshi House

Third Ward; vegan café

\$ [Walk-in](#)

[Sweets](#) [Brunch](#)

Coffee Cartel?

The Heights

verify **\$** [Walk-in](#)

[Sweets](#) [Brunch](#)

Zeke's?

verify **\$** [Walk-in](#)

[Sweets](#) [Brunch](#)

Café Poètes

Downtown; the bookshop café

\$ [Walk-in](#)

[Sweets](#) [Brunch](#)

Bayou City Coffee?

verify **\$** [Walk-in](#)

[Sweets](#) [Brunch](#)

Bebidas

Montrose; the juice

\$ [Walk-in](#)

[Sweets](#) [Brunch](#)

Nurture Kitchen?

verify **\$** **\$** [Walk-in](#)

[Sweets](#) [Brunch](#)

Coral Sword

Eastwood; the game café

\$ [Walk-in](#)

[Sweets](#) [Brunch](#)

Java Pura?

verify **\$** [Walk-in](#)

[Sweets](#) [Brunch](#)

Cafe Ginger?

Rice Village

verify **\$** **\$** [Walk-in](#)

[Sweets](#) [Brunch](#)

Toasted Yolk

multiple; breakfast chain

\$ **\$** [Walk-in](#)

[Sweets](#) [Brunch](#)

Ocean Tea?

verify **\$** [Walk-in](#)

[Sweets](#) [Brunch](#)

Phin Café?

Bellaire; Vietnamese coffee

verify **\$** [Walk-in](#)

[Sweets](#) [Brunch](#)

Cà Phê Sữa Đá at any Bellaire bánh mì counter

\$ [Walk-in](#)

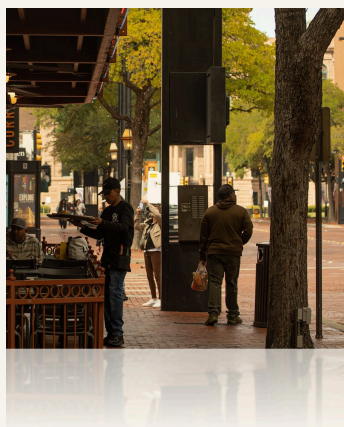
[Sweets](#) [Brunch](#)

Nguyen Ngo Bakery coffee

Bellaire

\$ [Walk-in](#)

[Sweets](#) [Brunch](#)



Restaurants · 152 places

Restaurants

Six stars, twenty-two Bibs, the Beard list, and the Bellaire, Hillcroft and Third Ward kitchens that make Houston the most diverse eating city in America.

Michelin's second Texas guide kept Houston's six stars — including CorkScrew, the first barbecue joint ever starred — and grew the Bibs to twenty-two, the most in the state. Underneath: the Beard list, five smokehouses on Texas Monthly's Top 50, and the Bellaire, Hillcroft and Third Ward kitchens that no guide can keep up with.

Why these Grouped by the Guide, then the Beard list and the classics. Street to Kitchen's Benchawan Painter won Best Chef: Texas; Himalaya and Crawfish & Noodles have been semifinalists for years; Ninfa's invented the fajita.

Michelin ★

March

Montrose; Felipe Riccio's Mediterranean tasting

★ \$\$\$\$ Tock Amex ✓
Romantic Date night

Le Jardinier

Museum of Fine Arts; Alain Verzeroli

★ \$\$\$\$ Resy Amex ✓
Romantic Date night

Musaafer

Galleria; Mayank Istwal's Indian tasting

★ \$\$\$\$ Resy Amex ✓
Romantic Date night

Tatemó

Spring Branch; Emmanuel Chavez's masa tasting

★ \$\$\$\$ Tock Amex ✓
Romantic Date night

BCN Taste & Tradition

Montrose; Spanish

★ \$\$\$\$ Resy Amex ✓
Romantic Date night

CorkScrew BBQ

Spring; the starred barbecue

★ TM50 \$\$ Walk-in
Casual Date night Group

Bib Gourmand (2025)

Annam

Autry Park; Vietnamese

Bib new \$\$ Resy Amex ✓
Casual Date night

Belly of the Beast

Spring

Bib \$\$\$ Resy Amex ✓
Date night

Blood Bros. BBQ

Bellaire; the Vietnamese-Texan smokehouse

Bib TM50 \$\$ Walk-in
Casual Date night Group

CasaEma

Montrose; Mexican

Bib \$\$ Resy Amex ✓
Casual Date night

ChòpnBlòk

Montrose

Bib new \$\$ Resy Amex ✓
Casual Date night

Da Gama Canteen

Heights

Bib new \$\$ Resy Amex ✓
Casual Date night

Killen's

Pearland; the steakhouse

Bib \$\$\$ OpenTable
Date night

Killen's BBQ

Pearland; Ronnie Killen

Bib TM50 \$\$ Walk-in
Casual Date night Group

Mala Sichuan Bistro

Montrose / Chinatown

Bib \$\$ Walk-in
Casual Date night Group

Máximo

Museum District

Bib new \$\$\$ Resy Amex ✓
Date night

Nam Giao

Bellaire

Bib \$ Walk-in
Casual

Nancy's Hustle

EaDo

Bib \$\$ Resy Amex ✓
Casual Date night

Nobie's

Montrose

Bib \$\$ Resy Amex ✓
Casual Date night

Papalo Taqueria

Houston Farmers Market

Bib new \$ Walk-in
Casual

Pinkerton's BBQ

Heights

Bib TM50 \$\$ Walk-in
Casual Date night Group

The Pit Room

Montrose; the tortillas

Bib TM50 \$\$ Walk-in
Casual Date night Group

Rosie Cannonball

Montrose

Bib \$\$\$ Resy Amex ✓
Date night

Rosemeyer Bar-B-Q

Spring

Bib \$\$ Walk-in
Casual Date night

Street to Kitchen

East End

Bib JBF \$\$ Resy Amex ✓
Casual Date night

Tejas Chocolate & Barbecue

Tomball; the drive

Bib TM50 \$\$ Walk-in
Casual Date night Group

Theodore Rex

Warehouse District

Bib \$\$\$ Resy Amex ✓
Date night

Truth BBQ

Heights; Leonard Botello

Bib TM50 \$\$ Walk-in
Casual Date night Group

Michelin recommended

Agnes and Sherman

Heights

MR new \$\$\$ Resy Amex ✓
Date night

Bar Bludorn

Montrose

MR new \$\$\$ Resy Amex ✓
Date night

Baso

Heights

MR \$\$\$ Resy Amex ✓
Date night

Bludorn

Montrose

MR \$\$\$\$ Resy Amex ✓
Romantic Date night

Brisket & Rice

Chinatown; Cambodian barbecue

MR \$ Walk-in
Casual

Candente

Montrose

MR \$\$ Resy Amex ✓
Casual Date night

Credence

Montrose; Michelin Service Award 2025

MR new \$\$\$\$ Resy Amex ✓
Romantic Date night

Hidden Omakase

Galleria

MR \$\$\$\$ Tock Amex ✓
Romantic Date night

Hong Kong Food Street

Chinatown

MR new \$\$ Walk-in
Casual Date night

J-Bar-M Barbecue

EaDo

MR new \$\$ Walk-in
Casual Date night

Josephine's

Montrose

MR new \$\$\$ Resy Amex ✓
Date night

Late August

Museum District

MR \$\$\$ Resy Amex ✓
Date night

Neo

Montrose; omakase

MR new verify temporarily closed \$\$\$\$
Tock Amex ✓
Romantic Date night

Pappas Bros. Steakhouse

Galleria / Downtown; Michelin Sommelier

Award 2024

MR \$\$\$\$ OpenTable
Romantic Date night Group

Perseid

Hotel Saint Augustine

MR new \$\$\$ Resy Amex ✓
Date night

The Marigold Club

Montrose

MR new \$\$\$ Resy Amex ✓
Date night

The Beard list & the classics

Hugo's

Montrose; Hugo Ortega

JBF 2026 semifinalist (Outstanding Restaurateur)

JBF \$\$\$ OpenTable
Date night Group

Xochi

Downtown

JBF \$\$\$ OpenTable
Date night Group

Caracol

Uptown

\$\$\$ [OpenTable](#)

[Date night](#)

Urbe

Uptown

\$\$ [OpenTable](#)

[Casual](#) [Date night](#)

Backstreet Café

River Oaks

\$\$\$ [OpenTable](#)

[Date night](#)

Himalaya

Mahatma Gandhi District

JB F \$\$ [Walk-in](#)

[Casual](#) [Date night](#)

Crawfish & Noodles

Bellaire

JB F \$\$ [Walk-in](#)

[Casual](#) [Date night](#) [Group](#)

Lucille's

Museum District

JB F \$\$\$ [OpenTable](#)

[Date night](#) [Group](#)

Georgia James

Regent Square

\$\$\$\$ [Resy](#) [Amex ✓](#)

[Romantic](#) [Date night](#) [Group](#)

Wild Oats

Houston Farmers Market

\$\$ [Resy](#) [Amex ✓](#)

[Casual](#) [Date night](#)

Navy Blue

Rice Village

\$\$\$\$ [Resy](#) [Amex ✓](#)

[Romantic](#) [Date night](#)

Ostia

Montrose

\$\$\$ [Resy](#) [Amex ✓](#)

[Date night](#)

Riel

Montrose

\$\$\$ [Resy](#) [Amex ✓](#)

[Date night](#)

Squable

Heights

\$\$\$ [Resy](#) [Amex ✓](#)

[Date night](#)

Coltivare

Heights

\$\$\$ [Walk-in](#)

[Date night](#)

Indianola

EaDo

\$\$ [Resy](#) [Amex ✓](#)

[Casual](#) [Date night](#)

Tiny Champions

EaDo

\$\$ [Resy](#) [Amex ✓](#)

[Casual](#) [Date night](#)

Better Luck Tomorrow

Heights

\$\$ [Walk-in](#)

[Casual](#) [Date night](#)

MAD

River Oaks District

\$\$\$ [OpenTable](#)

[Date night](#)

Ninfa's on Navigation

East End; since 1973

\$\$ [OpenTable](#)

[Casual](#) [Date night](#) [Group](#)

Irma's Original

Downtown; no menu, the lemonade

\$\$ [Walk-in](#)

[Casual](#) [Date night](#)

Molina's Cantina

multiple; since 1941

\$\$ [OpenTable](#)

[Casual](#) [Date night](#)

El Tiempo Cantina

multiple; the fajitas

\$\$ [OpenTable](#)

[Casual](#) [Date night](#)

Laredo Taqueria

Washington Ave; breakfast tacos

\$ [Walk-in](#)

[Casual](#)

Villa Arcos

East End; the breakfast taco line

\$ [Walk-in](#)

[Casual](#)

Tacos Tierra Caliente

Montrose; the truck by the ice house

\$ [Walk-in](#)

[Casual](#)

Taquería Arandas

multiple

\$ [Walk-in](#)

[Casual](#)

Gerardo's Drive-In

Northside; barbacoa on Sundays

\$ [Walk-in](#)

[Casual](#)

Taqueria Tacambaro

Canino's market

\$ [Walk-in](#)

[Casual](#)

Brothers Taco House

EaDo

\$ [Walk-in](#)

[Casual](#)

Doña María?

verify \$ [Walk-in](#)

[Casual](#)

Pho Binh

multiple; the trailer, Bellaire

\$ [Walk-in](#)

[Casual](#)

Pho Saigon

Bellaire / multiple

\$ [Walk-in](#)

[Casual](#)

Huynh

EaDo; the Vietnamese by the ballpark

\$\$ [Walk-in](#)

[Casual](#) [Date night](#)

Kim Son

multiple; the buffet, since 1982

\$\$ [Walk-in](#)

[Casual](#) [Date night](#) [Group](#)

Les Givral's

Midtown; bánh mì

\$ Walk-in

Casual

Cali Sandwich

Midtown; bánh mì

\$ Walk-in

Casual

Roostar

Heights / multiple; bánh mì

\$ Walk-in

Casual

Saigon House

Midtown; Viet-Cajun crawfish

\$\$ Walk-in

Casual Date night Group

Cajun Kitchen

Bellaire; Viet-Cajun crawfish

\$\$ Walk-in

Casual Date night Group

LA Crawfish

multiple

\$\$ Walk-in

Casual Date night

Fung's Kitchen

Southwest; the dim sum hall

\$\$ Walk-in

Casual Date night Group

Ocean Palace

Hong Kong City Mall; dim sum

\$\$ Walk-in

Casual Date night Group

Tim Ho Wan

Bellaire; the Hong Kong import

\$\$ Walk-in

Casual Date night

One Dragon

Bellaire; soup dumplings

\$\$ Walk-in

Casual Date night

Pepper Twins

Montrose / multiple; Sichuan

\$\$ Walk-in

Casual Date night

Cooking Girl

Montrose / Chinatown; Sichuan

\$\$ Walk-in

Casual Date night

Shabu House?

verify \$\$ Walk-in

Casual Date night

London Sizzler

Southwest; Indo-Pakistani

\$\$ Walk-in

Casual Date night

Shri Balaji Bhavan

Hillcroft; dosas

\$ Walk-in

Casual

Bombay Brasserie?

verify \$\$ Walk-in

Casual Date night

Aga's

Stafford; the Pakistani hall

\$\$ Walk-in

Casual Date night

Bijan Persian Grill

Hillcroft

\$\$ Walk-in

Casual Date night

Kasra

Westheimer; Persian

\$\$ Walk-in

Casual Date night

Garden Restaurant?

Persian

verify \$\$ Walk-in

Casual Date night

Al Aseel Grill & Café

Hillcroft; Lebanese

\$\$ Walk-in

Casual Date night

Fadi's Mediterranean

multiple; the cafeteria line

\$ Walk-in

Casual

Mary's Mediterranean

Montrose

\$\$ Walk-in

Casual Date night

Niko Niko's

Montrose; gyros since 1977

\$ Walk-in

Casual

Blue Nile Ethiopian

Southwest

\$\$ Walk-in

Casual Date night

Lucy Ethiopian?

verify \$\$ Walk-in

Casual Date night

Safari Restaurant?

verify \$\$ Walk-in

Casual Date night

Peli Peli

Galleria / Vintage Park; South African

\$\$\$ OpenTable

Date night

Finger Licking Bukateria

Southwest; Nigerian

\$ Walk-in

Casual

Sinh Sinh

Bellaire; 2am Cantonese

\$\$ Walk-in

Casual Date night

Mai's

Midtown; Vietnamese since 1978, late

\$\$ Walk-in

Casual Date night

Katz's Deli

Montrose; 24 hours, not the New York one

\$\$ Walk-in

Casual Date night

House of Pies

Kirby; 24 hours, the Bayou Goo

\$ Walk-in

Casual

Frank's Pizza

Downtown; the late slice

\$ Walk-in

Casual

Star Pizza

Montrose / Washington

\$\$ Walk-in

Casual Date night

Pizaro's

Memorial; Neapolitan

\$\$ Walk-in

Casual Date night

Antone's Famous Po'Boys

multiple; since 1962

\$ Walk-in

Casual

Burger-Chan

Greenway

\$ Walk-in

Casual

Bernie's Burger Bus

multiple

\$ Walk-in

Casual

Hubcap Grill

Downtown / Heights

\$ Walk-in

Casual

Lankford Grocery

Midtown; the burger since 1977

\$ Walk-in

Casual

Stanton's City Bites

Old Sixth Ward; the burger

\$ Walk-in

Casual

Whataburger

any; the honey butter chicken biscuit

\$ Walk-in

Casual

Frenchy's Chicken

Third Ward; since 1969

\$ Walk-in

Casual

Barbecue Inn

Northside; fried chicken, since 1946

\$\$ Walk-in

Casual Date night

The Breakfast Klub

Midtown; wings and waffles, the line

\$\$ Walk-in

Casual Date night

This Is It Soul Food

Third Ward; since 1959

\$ Walk-in

Casual

Burns Original BBQ

Acres Homes

TM50 \$\$ Walk-in

Casual Date night

Gatlin's BBQ

Northwest

TM50 \$\$ Walk-in

Casual Date night

Feges BBQ

Spring Branch / Greenway

\$\$ Walk-in

Casual Date night

Ray's BBQ Shack

Third Ward

\$\$ Walk-in

Casual Date night

Goode Co. Barbeque

Kirby; since 1977, the pecan pie

\$\$ Walk-in

Casual Date night Group

Goode Co. Seafood

Kirby; the campechana

\$\$ OpenTable

Casual Date night

Goode Co. Taqueria

Kirby; the breakfast

\$\$ Walk-in

Casual Date night

Brennan's of Houston

Midtown; the Creole cousin

\$\$\$\$ OpenTable

Romantic Date night

Tony's

Greenway; since 1965

\$\$\$\$ OpenTable

Romantic Date night

Mark's American Cuisine

closed

Da Marco

Montrose; Marco Wiles

\$\$\$\$ OpenTable

Romantic Date night

Dolce Vita

Montrose; Wiles' pizzeria

\$\$ OpenTable

Casual Date night

Nino's / Vincent's / Grappino di Nino

Montrose; the Mandola compound

\$\$\$ OpenTable

Date night

Carrabba's original

Kirby; the family one, not the chain

\$\$ OpenTable

Casual Date night

Rainbow Lodge

Heights

\$\$\$ OpenTable

Date night

Brasserie 19

River Oaks

\$\$\$ OpenTable

Date night

La Colombe d'Or

Montrose

\$\$\$\$ OpenTable

Romantic Date night

State of Grace

River Oaks; Ford Fry

\$\$\$ OpenTable

Date night

Pappadeaux

multiple; the Pappas seafood house

\$\$ Walk-in

Casual Date night Group

Pappasito's

multiple

\$\$ Walk-in

Casual Date night Group

Oxheart

closed

Underbelly

closed

UB Preserv

closed

One Fifth

closed

Reef

closed

Hay Merchant

closed



Brunch · 51 places

Brunch spots

The Breakfast Klub's line, Hugo's buffet, breakfast tacos on flour, dim sum in Asiatown.

The Breakfast Klub's line, Hugo's Sunday buffet, breakfast tacos on flour tortillas, dim sum at Ocean Palace, and Blacksmith's steak and eggs.

Why these Kept to places with a real kitchen at 10am. The taco counters are the local brunch; book the hotel rooms for the weekend.

The Breakfast Klub

Midtown; the line

\$\$ Walk-in

Brunch

Blacksmith

Montrose

\$\$ Walk-in

Brunch

Hugo's Sunday brunch

Montrose; the buffet

\$\$\$ OpenTable

Brunch

Backstreet Café brunch

\$\$\$ OpenTable

Brunch

Brennan's of Houston jazz brunch

\$\$\$\$ OpenTable

Brunch

Rainbow Lodge brunch

\$\$\$ OpenTable

Brunch

Coltivare brunch?

\$\$\$ Walk-in

Brunch

Squable brunch

\$\$\$ Resy Amex ✓

Brunch

Nancy's Hustle brunch?

\$\$ Resy Amex ✓

Brunch

Riel brunch

\$\$\$ Resy Amex ✓

Brunch

Ostia brunch

\$\$\$ Resy Amex ✓

Brunch

Bludorn brunch

MR \$\$\$\$ Resy Amex ✓

Brunch

Bar Bludorn brunch

MR \$\$\$ Resy Amex ✓

Brunch

Josephine's brunch

MR \$\$\$ Resy Amex ✓

Brunch

Late August brunch

MR \$\$\$ Resy Amex ✓

Brunch

Lucille's brunch

\$\$\$ OpenTable

Brunch

Máximo brunch

Bib \$\$\$ Resy Amex ✓

Brunch

Da Gama brunch

Bib \$\$ Resy Amex ✓

Brunch

ChòpnBlòk brunch

Bib \$\$ Resy Amex ✓

Brunch

Common Bond

Montrose

\$\$ Walk-in

Brunch

Koffeteria

EaDo

\$\$ Walk-in

Brunch

Morningstar

Heights

\$ Walk-in

Brunch

Lee's Fried Chicken & Donuts

\$ Walk-in

Brunch

Laredo Taqueria

breakfast tacos

\$ Walk-in

Brunch

Villa Arcos

breakfast tacos

\$ Walk-in

Brunch

Goode Co. Taqueria

the breakfast

\$\$ Walk-in

Brunch

Gerardo's

barbacoa on weekends

\$ Walk-in

Brunch

Tacos A Go Go

multiple

\$ Walk-in

Brunch

Snooze

multiple; the chain

\$\$ Walk-in

Brunch

Toasted Yolk

\$\$ Walk-in

Brunch

Buffalo Grille

multiple; the migas

\$\$ Walk-in

Brunch

House of Pies

24 hours

\$ Walk-in

Brunch

Katz's

24 hours

\$\$ Walk-in

Brunch

Baby Barnaby's

Montrose; breakfast, since 1992

\$\$ Walk-in

Brunch

Barnaby's Café

Montrose / multiple

\$\$ Walk-in

Brunch

Empire Café brunch

\$\$ Walk-in

Brunch

Brasil

Montrose

\$\$ Walk-in

Brunch

Dish Society

multiple

\$\$ Walk-in

Brunch

Harold's

Heights; Southern brunch

\$\$\$ OpenTable

Brunch

Cherry Block?

verify \$\$\$ Walk-in

Brunch

Ouzo Bay brunch

\$\$\$ OpenTable

Brunch

Brasserie 19 brunch

\$\$\$ OpenTable

Brunch

La Colombe d'Or brunch

\$\$\$\$ OpenTable

Brunch

State of Grace brunch

\$\$\$ OpenTable

Brunch

The Original Ninfa's brunch

\$\$ OpenTable

Brunch

Ocean Palace dim sum

\$\$ Walk-in

Brunch

Fung's Kitchen dim sum

\$\$ Walk-in

Brunch

Tim Ho Wan

\$\$ Walk-in

Brunch

Shri Balaji Bhavan

the weekend dosa

\$ Walk-in

Brunch

Nam Giao

bánh bèo for breakfast

Bib \$ Walk-in

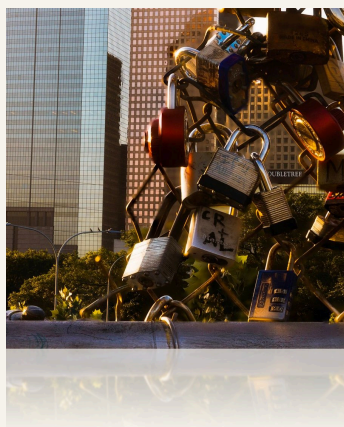
Brunch

Pho Binh

the trailer at 8am

\$ Walk-in

Brunch



Off-beat · 52 places

Off-beat & only-in-Houston

A starred barbecue joint, Viet-Cajun crawfish, the fajita's birthplace, a 24-hour pie house, and a farmers market with a Bib taquería.

A Michelin star for brisket, Viet-Cajun crawfish invented on Bellaire, the fajita's birthplace on Navigation, barbacoa on Sundays at a drive-in, a 24-hour pie house, and a farmers market with a Bib taquería.

Why these Selected for singularity. The barbecue Top 50 and the Asiatown night are the two things Houston does that no other city on this list can.

Truth BBQ

Heights; the line

Bib TM50 \$\$ Walk-in
Casual

The Pit Room

Montrose; brisket tacos on lard tortillas

Bib TM50 \$\$ Walk-in
Casual

Pinkerton's

Heights; the glazed ribs

Bib TM50 \$\$ Walk-in
Casual

Blood Bros.

Bellaire; brisket fried rice, Thai green curry boudin

Bib TM50 \$\$ Walk-in
Casual

Killen's BBQ

Pearland; the beef rib

Bib TM50 \$\$ Walk-in
Casual

CorkScrew BBQ

Spring; a Michelin star for brisket

★ TM50 \$\$ Walk-in
Casual

Tejas Chocolate & Barbecue

Tomball

Bib TM50 \$\$ Walk-in
Casual

Burns Original

Acres Homes; since 1973

TM50 \$\$ Walk-in
Casual

Gatlin's

Northwest

TM50 \$\$ Walk-in
Casual

Brisket & Rice

Chinatown; Cambodian barbecue

MR \$ Walk-in
Casual

Gerardo's Drive-In

Northside; barbacoa de cabeza on Sundays

\$ Walk-in
Casual

Villa Arcos

East End; the breakfast taco since 1977

\$ Walk-in
Casual

Laredo Taqueria

Washington Ave

\$ Walk-in
Casual

Tacos Tierra Caliente

the truck at West Alabama Ice House

\$ Walk-in
Casual

Ninfa's on Navigation

the fajita was invented here, 1973

\$\$ OpenTable
Casual

Irma's Original

no menu, cash

\$\$ Walk-in
Casual

Crawfish & Noodles

Viet-Cajun crawfish, the Houston invention

JBf \$\$ Walk-in
Casual

Cajun Kitchen

Bellaire

\$\$ Walk-in
Casual

Pho Binh trailer

Bellaire; since 1983

\$ Walk-in

Casual

Sinh Sinh at 2am

Bellaire

\$\$ Walk-in

Casual

Hong Kong City Mall

Bellaire; the food court

\$ Walk-in

Casual

Houston Farmers Market

Airline Dr; Papalo, Underbelly Burger, Wild Oats, the produce

\$ Walk-in

Casual

Canino's Produce and Taqueria Tacambaro

\$ Walk-in

Casual

Hillcroft

the Mahatma Gandhi District; Himalaya, Shri Balaji, the sweet shops

\$ Walk-in

Casual

Bellaire Boulevard at midnight

\$ Walk-in

Casual

Frenchy's Chicken

Third Ward

\$ Walk-in

Casual

This Is It Soul Food

Third Ward

\$ Walk-in

Casual

Barbecue Inn

the fried chicken, since 1946

\$\$ Walk-in

Casual

House of Pies at 3am

Kirby

\$ Walk-in

Casual

Katz's Deli

24 hours, Montrose

\$\$ Walk-in

Casual

Whataburger after midnight

\$ Walk-in

Casual

Shipley's

the glazed, since 1936

\$ Walk-in

Casual

Lee's Fried Chicken & Donuts

Heights; the drive-through

\$ Walk-in

Casual

Lankford Grocery

the Grim Reaper burger

\$ Walk-in

Casual

Antone's

the po'boy since 1962

\$ Walk-in

Casual

Goode Co.

the pecan pie in the wooden box

\$\$ Walk-in

Casual

Molina's Cantina

Tex-Mex since 1941

\$\$ OpenTable

Casual

Pappas Bros.

the wine list, 3,000 labels

MR \$\$\$\$ OpenTable

Casual

Tony's

since 1965; the society room

\$\$\$\$ OpenTable

Casual

West Alabama Ice House

since 1928; the taco truck, the dogs

\$ Walk-in

Casual

Alice's Tall Texan

the goblet

\$ Walk-in

Casual

La Carafe

the oldest bar, cash, candles

\$ Walk-in

Casual

Marfireless

the blue door

\$\$ Walk-in

Casual

Anvil's 100 list

JBF \$\$ Walk-in

Casual

The Continental Club

Midtown

\$ Walk-in

Casual

Neon Boots

the country dancehall

\$ Walk-in

Casual

Rodeo Houston

March; the fried everything

\$\$ Walk-in

Casual

Buffalo Bayou Cistern

\$ Walk-in

Casual

Post Houston

the old post office; Skylawn

\$ Walk-in

Casual

Space Center Houston

then a Whataburger on the way back

\$\$ Walk-in

Casual

Galveston day

Gaido's since 1911, the drive

\$\$\$ [OpenTable](#)

Casual

Killen's Steakhouse

Pearland; a Bib steakhouse

Bib \$\$\$ [OpenTable](#)

Casual



Bakeries · 50 places

Bakeries

Kolaches, pan dulce, bánh mì loaves, Beard-nominated pastry, and Shipley's since 1936.

Kolaches (Czech, by way of the Hill Country), pan dulce at El Bolillo, bánh mì loaves in Bellaire, Beard-nominated pastry at Koffeteria and Fluff, and Shipley's glazed since 1936.

Why these Chosen on the strength of one item each. Common Bond is the all-rounder; Three Brothers has been baking since 1949.

Common Bond

Montrose / multiple

\$ Walk-in

Sweets Brunch

Koffeteria

EaDo; Vanarin Kuch

JBF **\$** Walk-in

Sweets Brunch

Morningstar

Heights

\$ Walk-in

Sweets Brunch

Shipley Do-Nuts

since 1936

\$ Walk-in

Sweets Brunch

Christy's Donuts

Montrose

\$ Walk-in

Sweets Brunch

Lee's Fried Chicken & Donuts

Heights

\$ Walk-in

Sweets Brunch

Glazed?

Doughnut Wonderland

verify **\$** Walk-in

Sweets Brunch

Three Brothers Bakery

Braeswood; since 1949

\$ Walk-in

Sweets Brunch

Moeller's Bakery

Bellaire; petits fours

\$ Walk-in

Sweets Brunch

Michael's Cookie Jar

Bellaire

\$ Walk-in

Sweets Brunch

Fluff Bake Bar

Montrose; Rebecca Masson

JBF **\$** Walk-in

Sweets Brunch

Cake & Bacon?

verify **\$** Walk-in

Sweets Brunch

Bakery Lorraine?

verify **\$** Walk-in

Sweets Brunch

Pondicheri Bake Lab

Upper Kirby; Anita Jaisinghani

JBF **\$** Walk-in

Sweets Brunch

Slow Dough Bread Co.

Heights; the wholesale bakery

\$ Walk-in

Sweets Brunch

Magnol French Baking

Washington Ave

\$ Walk-in

Sweets Brunch

Kraftsmen Bakery

Montrose

\$ Walk-in

Sweets Brunch

Tout Suite

EaDo

\$ Walk-in

Sweets Brunch

Nguyen Ngo Bakery

Bellaire; bánh mì bread

\$ Walk-in

Sweets Brunch

Hong Kong Food Street bakery counter?

MR **\$** Walk-in

Sweets Brunch

Six Ping Bakery

Bellaire; Taiwanese

\$ [Walk-in](#)
[Sweets](#) [Brunch](#)

85°C

Bellaire / multiple

\$ [Walk-in](#)
[Sweets](#) [Brunch](#)

Paris Baguette

multiple

\$ [Walk-in](#)
[Sweets](#) [Brunch](#)

Tous les Jours

multiple

\$ [Walk-in](#)
[Sweets](#) [Brunch](#)

El Bolillo

multiple; the pan dulce, the tres leches

\$ [Walk-in](#)
[Sweets](#) [Brunch](#)

Panadería Nuevo León?

verify \$ [Walk-in](#)
[Sweets](#) [Brunch](#)

La Guadalupana Bakery & Café

Montrose; the pastries, the breakfast

\$ [Walk-in](#)
[Sweets](#) [Brunch](#)

Angelo's Bakery?

verify \$ [Walk-in](#)
[Sweets](#) [Brunch](#)

Rustika Café

multiple; Argentine, the empanadas

\$\$ [Walk-in](#)
[Sweets](#) [Brunch](#)

Phoenicia Specialty Foods

Downtown / Westchase; the bakery inside

\$ [Walk-in](#)
[Sweets](#) [Brunch](#)

Al Aseel bakery counter?

verify \$ [Walk-in](#)
[Sweets](#) [Brunch](#)

Raja Sweets

Hillcroft; since 1985

\$ [Walk-in](#)
[Sweets](#) [Brunch](#)

Bombay Sweets?

verify \$ [Walk-in](#)
[Sweets](#) [Brunch](#)

Alpha Bakery

Bellaire

\$ [Walk-in](#)
[Sweets](#) [Brunch](#)

Dessert Gallery

Upper Kirby / Galleria; Sara Brook

\$\$ [Walk-in](#)
[Sweets](#) [Brunch](#)

Ooh La La

multiple; the cupcakes

\$ [Walk-in](#)
[Sweets](#) [Brunch](#)

Crumbville TX

Third Ward; the stuffed cookies

\$ [Walk-in](#)
[Sweets](#) [Brunch](#)

Petite Sweets

Montrose

\$ [Walk-in](#)
[Sweets](#) [Brunch](#)

Manena's Pastry Shop

Bellaire; Argentine

\$ [Walk-in](#)
[Sweets](#) [Brunch](#)

Dandelion Café?

verify \$\$ [Walk-in](#)
[Sweets](#) [Brunch](#)

Sweet Paris

crêpes

\$\$ [Walk-in](#)
[Sweets](#) [Brunch](#)

Pena's Donut Heaven

Pearland

\$ [Walk-in](#)
[Sweets](#) [Brunch](#)

River Oaks Donuts

\$ [Walk-in](#)
[Sweets](#) [Brunch](#)

Hugs & Donuts

Heights

\$ [Walk-in](#)
[Sweets](#) [Brunch](#)

Voodoo Doughnut

Montrose; the Portland import

\$ [Walk-in](#)
[Sweets](#) [Brunch](#)

Rise Kitchen?

verify \$ [Walk-in](#)
[Sweets](#) [Brunch](#)

Tejas Chocolate

the chocolate half

Bib \$ [Walk-in](#)
[Sweets](#) [Brunch](#)

Cacao & Cardamom

Galleria; the chocolatier

\$\$ [Walk-in](#)
[Sweets](#) [Brunch](#)

Bread Man Baking Co.

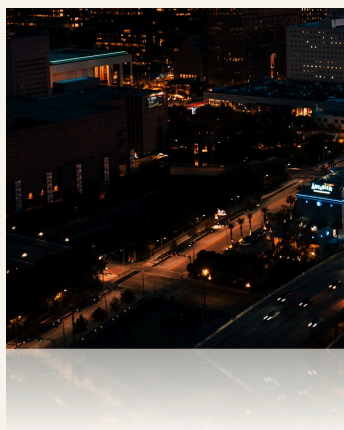
the wholesale loaf at the farmers market

\$ [Walk-in](#)
[Sweets](#) [Brunch](#)

Yummy's?

Bellaire; Cantonese bakery

verify \$ [Walk-in](#)
[Sweets](#) [Brunch](#)



Dessert • 50 places

Dessert bars & sweets

The Bayou Goo, pecan pie in a wooden box, bingsu on Bellaire, tres leches everywhere.

The Bayou Goo at House of Pies, Goode Co.'s pecan pie, bingsu and boba on Bellaire, tres leches at Ninfa's, and the pastry courses at the starred rooms.

Why these A mix of the destination and the institution. House of Pies at 3am is the pilgrimage.

House of Pies

the Bayou Goo, 24 hours

\$ Walk-in

Sweets

Goode Co. pecan pie

\$\$ Walk-in

Sweets

Fluff Bake Bar

Montrose

JBF \$\$ Walk-in

Sweets

Dessert Gallery

\$\$ Walk-in

Sweets

Cloud 10 Creamery

Rice Village; Chris Leung

\$ Walk-in

Sweets

Fat Cat Creamery

Heights

\$ Walk-in

Sweets

Sweet Bribery?

verify \$ Walk-in

Sweets

Jeni's

Montrose / Heights

\$ Walk-in

Sweets

Amy's Ice Creams

the Austin one

\$ Walk-in

Sweets

Hank's Ice Cream

South Main; since 1985

\$ Walk-in

Sweets

La Paletera

multiple; paletas

\$ Walk-in

Sweets

Raspas at any Northside truck

\$ Walk-in

Sweets

Bingsu at Sul & Beans

Bellaire

\$ Walk-in

Sweets

Meet Fresh

Bellaire; Taiwanese

\$ Walk-in

Sweets

Cafe 101?

Bellaire

verify \$ Walk-in

Sweets

Nu Café?

Bellaire; Vietnamese sweets

verify \$ Walk-in

Sweets

Chè at Lee's Sandwiches?

\$ Walk-in

Sweets

Raja Sweets

Hillcroft

\$ Walk-in

Sweets

Kulfi at Shri Balaji

\$ Walk-in

Sweets

Tres leches at El Bolillo

\$ Walk-in

Sweets

Tres leches at Ninfa's

\$\$ OpenTable

Sweets

Flan at Hugo's

\$\$\$ OpenTable

Sweets

Churros at Urbe

\$\$ [OpenTable](#)

Sweets

Chocolate at Tejas

Bib \$ [Walk-in](#)

Sweets

Cacao & Cardamom

\$\$ [Walk-in](#)

Sweets

Tout Suite

\$\$ [Walk-in](#)

Sweets

Koffeteria

the kolaches and the cakes

\$\$ [Walk-in](#)

Sweets

Common Bond's cakes

\$\$ [Walk-in](#)

Sweets

Empire Café

half-price cake Mondays

\$\$ [Walk-in](#)

Sweets

Three Brothers Bakery

the cakes

\$ [Walk-in](#)

Sweets

Moeller's petits fours

\$ [Walk-in](#)

Sweets

Michael's Cookie Jar

\$ [Walk-in](#)

Sweets

Crumbville TX

\$ [Walk-in](#)

Sweets

Kolaches at Kolache Shoppe

Timbergrove; since 1970

\$ [Walk-in](#)

Sweets

Kolaches at Shipley's

\$ [Walk-in](#)

Sweets

Kolaches at Weikel's

La Grange; the drive to Austin

\$ [Walk-in](#)

Sweets

Dessert at March

★ \$\$\$\$ [Tock](#) [Amex](#) ✓

Sweets

Dessert at Musaafer

the Indian pastry

★ \$\$\$\$ [Resy](#) [Amex](#) ✓

Sweets

Dessert at Le Jardinier

★ \$\$\$\$ [Resy](#) [Amex](#) ✓

Sweets

Bread pudding at Brennan's of Houston

\$\$\$\$ [OpenTable](#)

Sweets

Frozen custard at Ritter's?

verify \$ [Walk-in](#)

Sweets

Snow cones at Snow Cone Lady?

verify \$ [Walk-in](#)

Sweets

Baked Alaska at Tony's

\$\$\$\$ [OpenTable](#)

Sweets

Mochi donuts at Mochinut

multiple

\$ [Walk-in](#)

Sweets

Boba at Teahouse

Bellaire / multiple; the Houston chain

\$ [Walk-in](#)

Sweets

Boba at Tapioca House

Bellaire

\$ [Walk-in](#)

Sweets

Pies at Flying Saucer Pie Co.

Northside; since 1967

\$ [Walk-in](#)

Sweets

Doberge at Three Brothers

\$ [Walk-in](#)

Sweets

Cheesecake at Nino's

the Mandola one

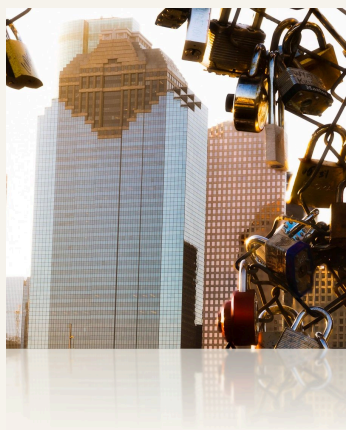
\$\$\$ [OpenTable](#)

Sweets

Cookies at Hugs & Donuts?

verify \$ [Walk-in](#)

Sweets



Scene · 51 places

Notable mentions

Where the room is the point: Tony's since 1965, Pappas Bros.' cellar, the River Oaks District, the starred tasting rooms.

Where the room is the point: Tony's since 1965, Pappas Bros.' 3,000-bottle cellar, the River Oaks District, Bludorn's dining room, and the starred tasting counters.

Why these The old rooms lead; the hotel bars and the steakhouses follow. The Galleria restaurants are on because that's where Houston celebrates.

Tony's

Greenway

\$\$\$\$ OpenTable

Romantic Group

Pappas Bros. Steakhouse

Galleria

MR \$\$\$\$ OpenTable

Romantic Group

Georgia James

\$\$\$\$ Resy Amex ✓

Romantic Group

Bludorn

MR \$\$\$\$ Resy Amex ✓

Romantic Group

Navy Blue

\$\$\$\$ Resy Amex ✓

Romantic Group

Le Jardinier

MFAH

★ \$\$\$\$ Resy Amex ✓

Romantic Group

March

★ \$\$\$\$ Tock Amex ✓

Romantic Group

Musaafer

the Galleria palace

★ \$\$\$\$ Resy Amex ✓

Romantic Group

Credence

the service award

MR \$\$\$\$ Resy Amex ✓

Romantic Group

The Marigold Club

MR \$\$\$ Resy Amex ✓

Group Date night

Perseid

Hotel Saint Augustine

MR \$\$\$ Resy Amex ✓

Group Date night

Bisou

River Oaks District; the scene

\$\$\$\$ SevenRooms

Romantic Group

MAD

River Oaks District

\$\$\$ OpenTable

Group Date night

Ouzo Bay

River Oaks District

\$\$\$ OpenTable

Group Date night

Toca Madera

River Oaks District

\$\$\$\$ SevenRooms

Romantic Group

Steak 48

River Oaks District

\$\$\$\$ OpenTable

Romantic Group

Mastro's

Post Oak

\$\$\$\$ OpenTable

Romantic Group

Bludorn's Bar

MR \$\$\$ Resy Amex ✓

Group Date night

Brennan's of Houston

\$\$\$\$ OpenTable

Romantic Group

La Colombe d'Or

\$\$\$\$ OpenTable

Romantic Group

Da Marco

\$\$\$\$ OpenTable

Romantic Group

Ostia

\$\$\$ Resy Amex ✓

Group Date night

Rosie Cannonball

Bib \$\$\$ Resy Amex ✓
Group Date night

Squable

\$\$\$ Resy Amex ✓
Group Date night

Nancy's Hustle

Bib \$\$ Resy Amex ✓
Group Date night

Hugo's

\$\$\$ OpenTable
Group Date night

Xochi

\$\$\$ OpenTable
Group Date night

Caracol

\$\$\$ OpenTable
Group Date night

Brasserie 19

\$\$\$ OpenTable
Group Date night

State of Grace

\$\$\$ OpenTable
Group Date night

Backstreet Café

\$\$\$ OpenTable
Group Date night

Rainbow Lodge

\$\$\$ OpenTable
Group Date night

The Post Oak Hotel's Bloom & Bee

\$\$\$\$ OpenTable
Romantic Group

Toro Toro

Four Seasons
\$\$\$ OpenTable
Group Date night

Bayou & Bottle

Four Seasons; the bourbon
\$\$\$ Walk-in
Group Date night

Z on 23

Le Méridien
\$\$ Walk-in
Group Date night

Marfireless

\$\$ Walk-in
Group Date night

Anvil

\$\$ Walk-in
Group Date night

Julep

\$\$ Walk-in
Group Date night

Tongue-Cut Sparrow

\$\$ Walk-in
Group Date night

Sambuca

jazz dinner
\$\$\$ OpenTable
Group Date night

Cezanne

the jazz room
\$\$ Walk-in
Group Date night

Hidden Omakase

MR \$\$\$\$ Tock Amex ✓
Romantic Group

Neo

MR verify \$\$\$\$ Tock Amex ✓
Romantic Group

Tatemó

the eight seats
★ \$\$\$\$ Tock Amex ✓
Romantic Group

Kata Robata

Upper Kirby; the sushi scene
\$\$\$ OpenTable
Group Date night

Uchi Houston

Montrose
\$\$\$\$ OpenTable
Romantic Group

Nobu Houston

Galleria
\$\$\$\$ OpenTable
Romantic Group

The Annie Café & Bar

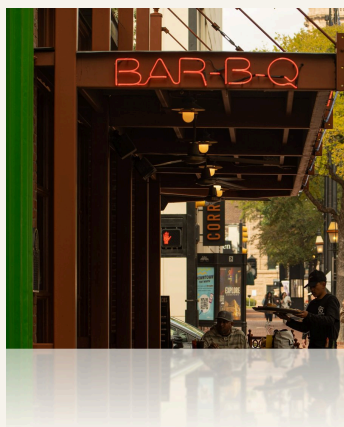
Galleria; Ben Berg
\$\$\$\$ OpenTable
Romantic Group

B&B Butchers

Washington Ave
\$\$\$\$ OpenTable
Romantic Group

Turner's

Washington Ave; the supper club
\$\$\$\$ OpenTable
Romantic Group



Nightlife · 52 places

Dance clubs & nightlife

The Continental Club, White Oak's lawn, Numbers since 1978, and a country dancehall in the northwest.

The Continental Club and the Big Top, White Oak's lawn, the Heights Theater, Numbers since 1978, Rich's, and Neon Boots for the two-step.

Why these Venues and clubs together. Fitzgerald's and Walter's are listed closed so you know what the scene lost.

The Continental Club

Midtown

\$ Walk-in

Late night Group

White Oak Music Hall

Near Northside; the lawn, the rooms

\$\$ Walk-in

Late night Group

Warehouse Live Midtown

\$\$ Walk-in

Late night Group

House of Blues Houston

Downtown

\$\$ Walk-in

Late night Group

713 Music Hall

Post Houston

\$\$ Walk-in

Late night Group

Bayou Music Center

Downtown

\$\$ Walk-in

Late night Group

The Heights Theater

\$\$ Walk-in

Late night Group

Rudyard's

the upstairs stage

\$ Walk-in

Late night Group

Numbers

Montrose; since 1978

\$ Walk-in

Late night Group

Rich's

Midtown

\$\$ Walk-in

Late night Group

JR's

Montrose

\$ Walk-in

Late night Group

South Beach?

closed

Eagle Houston

\$ Walk-in

Late night Group

Pearl Bar

\$ Walk-in

Late night Group

Barbarella

Midtown

\$ Walk-in

Late night Group

Clé

Midtown; the megaclub

\$\$\$ SevenRooms

Late night Group

Spire

Downtown; the old church

\$\$\$ Walk-in

Late night Group

Stereo Live

Midtown; EDM

\$\$ Walk-in

Late night Group

Bar 5015?

verify \$\$ Walk-in

Late night Group

The Secret Group

EaDo

\$ Walk-in

Late night Group

Neil's Bahr

EaDo

\$ Walk-in

Late night Group

Lucky's Pub

EaDo

\$ Walk-in

Late night Group

Truck Yard

EaDo

\$ Walk-in

Late night Group

Howl at the Moon

\$\$ Walk-in

Late night Group

Dirt Bar

Downtown

\$ Walk-in

Late night Group

Notsuoh

Downtown

\$ Walk-in

Late night Group

Little Dipper

Downtown

\$ Walk-in

Late night Group

Rebels Honky Tonk

\$ Walk-in

Late night Group

Neon Boots

Northwest; country

\$ Walk-in

Late night Group

Wild West

Northwest; the dancehall

\$ Walk-in

Late night Group

Goode's Armadillo Palace

Kirby

\$\$ Walk-in

Late night Group

McGonigel's Mucky Duck

\$\$ Walk-in

Late night Group

The Big Easy

Upper Kirby; blues

\$ Walk-in

Late night Group

Cezanne

Montrose; jazz

\$\$ Walk-in

Late night Group

Sambuca

Downtown; jazz

\$\$\$ OpenTable

Late night Group

Last Concert Café

Warehouse District; the hidden yard, knock

\$\$ Walk-in

Late night Group

The Nightingale Room

\$\$ Walk-in

Late night Group

Bad News Bar

\$\$ Walk-in

Late night Group

Dean's

Downtown

\$ Walk-in

Late night Group

Moving Sidewalk

\$\$ Walk-in

Late night Group

Reserve 101

\$\$ Walk-in

Late night Group

Axelrad

Midtown; the yard, the DJs

\$ Walk-in

Late night Group

The Dogwood

Midtown

\$ Walk-in

Late night Group

Wooster's Garden

\$\$ Walk-in

Late night Group

Present Company

\$\$ Walk-in

Late night Group

Grand Prize Bar

\$ Walk-in

Late night Group

Poison Girl

\$ Walk-in

Late night Group

The Flat

Montrose

\$ Walk-in

Late night Group

Boondocks

Montrose

\$ Walk-in

Late night Group

Etro Lounge?

closed

Fitzgerald's

closed

Walter's Downtown

closed



Itineraries · for a first-time visitor

Just follow this.

Three ready-made food itineraries — one, three and five days — built only from places on this list, so a first-time visitor can eat well without doing the research.

Each plan runs on foot and by subway, one borough a day, with a big dinner every night and a backup for every table that's hard to get. Times are suggestions; the order matters more than the clock.

How to use it Book the starred dinners the morning reservations open, then walk everything else. The gotchas on the last page cover the rest: cash, tickets, tipping, dress codes, and the Amex credit.

Itinerary · One day

One day

Breakfast tacos, a Bib barbecue line, Bellaire at night. One day in the most diverse food city in America.

One day, by car — Houston doesn't walk. Book one dinner. **Book one thing: dinner at Nancy's Hustle or Street to Kitchen (Resy) — or March (Tock) if you're splurging.**

The day

- | | |
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| 7:30 | Villa Arcos (East End)
Breakfast tacos on flour tortillas since 1977; the line moves. Then Laredo Taqueria on Washington if you're still hungry. |
| <hr/> | |
| 9:30 | Houston Farmers Market (Airline Dr)
Papalo Taqueria (a Bib), the produce halls, Underbelly Burger for later. The most Houston hour of the day. |
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| 11:00 | Truth BBQ or The Pit Room
Get in line by eleven at Truth (Heights) for brisket and the beef rib; or the Pit Room in Montrose, where the tortillas are made with brisket fat. Both are Bibs. |
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| 2:00 | Menil Collection, then Blacksmith
The free museum; then a Vietnamese coffee and the steak-and-eggs at Blacksmith on Westheimer. |
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| 5:00 | Anvil Bar & Refuge (Montrose)
Bobby Heugel's bar — the 100-list cocktails, the reason Houston drinks well. Walk-in; early is the move. |
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| 7:30 | Nancy's Hustle (EaDo) or Street to Kitchen (East End)
The Hustle Bread and the tartare, or Benchawan Painter's Beard-winning Thai. Both Bibs, both Resy. |
| <hr/> | |
| 10:00 | Bellaire Boulevard
Sinh Sinh for Cantonese at midnight, or Pho Binh's trailer if it's still open. The last stop is always Asiatown. |

Three days

Barbecue, Asiatown, the starred rooms. Three days that cover the three Houstons.

Three days by car. Book two dinners and one barbecue line. **Book: March or Tatemó (Tock), Bludorn or Le Jardinier (Resy). Everything else is a line or a walk-in.**

Day 1 — Montrose and the Heights

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| 8:00 | Blacksmith (Montrose)
Vietnamese steak and eggs, a cortado, the courtyard. |
| 10:30 | Truth BBQ (Heights)
The line for the Bib brisket; get there before it opens at eleven. Beef rib, brisket, tres leches. |
| 1:30 | Common Bond or Morningstar
A pastry to walk off the barbecue; Morningstar's donuts if it's the Heights. |
| 4:00 | Better Luck Tomorrow (Heights)
Justin Yu and Bobby Heugel's neighborhood bar; the snacks are a Bib chef's. |
| 6:00 | Julep (Washington Ave)
Alba Huerta's Southern cocktails; the julep list is the point. |
| 8:00 | Bludorn (Montrose) or Rosie Cannonball
Aaron Bludorn's Michelin-recommended room, or Goodnight's wood-fired Bib. Resy. |
| 10:30 | Marfreless (River Oaks)
The blue door, no sign, since 1976. Quiet. |

Day 2 — Asiatown and the East End

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| 9:00 | Nam Giao (Bellaire)
Hue-style Vietnamese breakfast — bánh bèo, bún bò Huế — at a Bib that costs ten dollars. |
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| 11:00 | Hong Kong City Mall
The food court, the bakeries, the grocery; Ocean Palace for dim sum if you'd rather sit. |
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| 1:00 | Crawfish & Noodles (Bellaire)
Trong Nguyen's Viet-Cajun crawfish — the dish Houston invented. In season February to June; the salt-and-pepper blue crab otherwise. |
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| 3:30 | Blood Bros. BBQ (Bellaire)
Brisket fried rice and Thai green curry boudin from a Bib smokehouse. They sell out; go before four. |
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| 6:00 | Mala Sichuan Bistro (Montrose)
A Bib Sichuan room; the water-boiled fish and the cumin lamb. |
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| 8:00 | Street to Kitchen (East End)
Benchawan Painter's Thai, cooked at Bangkok strength. Resy. |
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| 10:00 | Moon Tower Inn (East End)
Hot dogs and a wall of beer in a yard by the tracks. |
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- ## Day 3 — Downtown, the Museum District and the stars
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| 8:00 | Laredo Taqueria (Washington Ave)
Breakfast tacos at the counter; the carne guisada. |
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10:00	Museum of Fine Arts, then Le Jardinier The Kinder building; Alain Verzeroli's starred vegetable-forward lunch inside the museum. Resy.
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2:00	Buffalo Bayou Cistern The underground reservoir; book the tour.
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4:00	La Carafe (Market Square) Candles, cash, the oldest bar in Houston. One drink.
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5:30	Tongue-Cut Sparrow (Downtown) Upstairs from the Pastry War; the rules are posted, the drinks are exact.
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8:00	March (Montrose) or Tatemó (Spring Branch) Felipe Riccio's Mediterranean tasting, or Emmanuel Chavez's eight-seat masa tasting. Tock, weeks out.
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10:30	The Continental Club (Midtown) Whoever's on; the Big Top next door if it's full.
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Five days

The three-day plan, plus a barbecue pilgrimage north and a day of Hillcroft and the Third Ward.

Five days by car. Book three dinners and one steakhouse. **Add to the three-day bookings: Musaafer (Resy), Pappas Bros. (OpenTable), Killen's Steakhouse (OpenTable).**

Days 1–3

- **The three-day plan**
As above.

Day 4 — North: the starred smokehouse

- 9:30 **CorkScrew BBQ (Spring)**
The barbecue joint with a Michelin star; the line forms before ten. Brisket, ribs, the sausage.
- 12:30 **Tejas Chocolate & Barbecue (Tomball)**
A chocolate shop that became a Top 50 smokehouse; the carrot soufflé is the side.
- 3:00 **Killen's (Pearland) — the drive south**
Ronnie Killen's beef rib at the barbecue, then the Bib steakhouse next door for dinner. OpenTable.
- 7:30 **Killen's Steakhouse (Pearland)**
The dry-aged bone-in ribeye; a Bib for a steakhouse, which is rare.
- 10:00 **Neon Boots (Northwest)**
The country dancehall; two-step lessons early, the floor late.

Day 5 — Hillcroft, the Third Ward and the old rooms

9:00 **Shri Balaji Bhavan (Hillcroft)**

Dosas and filter coffee in the Mahatma Gandhi District.

11:30 **Himalaya (Hillcroft)**

Kaiser Lashkari's Indo-Pakistani kitchen — a Beard semifinalist for years. The chicken hara masala and the biryani.

2:00 **Frenchy's (Third Ward)**

Creole fried chicken since 1969; a two-piece and a side.

4:00 **This Is It Soul Food (Third Ward)**

Oxtails and greens from the cafeteria line, since 1959.

6:00 **Bayou & Bottle (Four Seasons)**

The bourbon library; a pre-dinner pour.

8:00 **Musaafer (Galleria) or Pappas Bros.**

Mayank Istwal's starred Indian tasting in a room built like a palace, or the steakhouse with 3,000 wines. Resy / OpenTable.

10:30 **House of Pies (Kirby)**

The Bayou Goo pie, 24 hours. The right end to Houston.

Before you go.

The things New Yorkers know and visitors learn the expensive way.

You need a car.

Houston is 665 square miles and the food is spread across all of it — Bellaire is twenty minutes from Montrose, Pearland forty, Spring an hour. Rideshare works inside the Loop; a rental is cheaper for two days or more. The light rail covers Downtown, Midtown and the Museum District only.

Barbecue is a morning meal.

Truth, the Pit Room, Pinkerton's, Blood Bros., Killen's and CorkScrew open at eleven and sell out of brisket by early afternoon. Be in line by 10:30 on weekends; weekdays are gentler. Order by the pound, and get the sides.

Tock for the counters, Resy for the rooms, OpenTable for the Pappas family.

March, Tatemó and Hidden Omakase sell tickets on Tock, weeks out. Bludorn, Le Jardinier, Musaafer, BCN and the Bibs are Resy, 30 days out. Pappas Bros., Hugo's, Xochi and the old rooms are OpenTable.

Crawfish season.

Viet-Cajun crawfish runs February to June; Crawfish & Noodles and Cajun Kitchen are the reason to come in spring. Outside the season, order the salt-and-pepper blue crab instead.

Bellaire after dark.

Asiatown runs late — Sinh Sinh until 2am, the boba shops until midnight, Pho Binh's trailer from dawn. It's a strip-mall city; park once per block and walk.

Cash at the counters.

Villa Arcos, Gerardo's, Tacos Tierra Caliente, La Carafe, Irma's and most of Hillcroft are cash-first. Carry \$60 on the taco day.

The heat.

May to October, plan the outdoor stops — the ice houses, the beer gardens, the barbecue lines — for before eleven or after six. Everything indoors is over-air-conditioned; carry a layer.

The Amex credit.

Resy runs the Platinum dining credit; Bludorn, Le Jardinier, Musaafer, Nancy's Hustle, Rosie Cannonball, Squable and most of the Bibs book through it. Tock and OpenTable rooms don't count.

Notes

Michelin: the second Texas selection, announced October 28, 2025 at the Wortham Theater Center. Houston kept its six one-stars — BCN Taste & Tradition, CorkScrew BBQ (the first barbecue restaurant ever starred, in 2024), Le Jardinier, March, Musaafer and Tatemó — and grew to twenty-two Bib Gourmands with Annam, ChòpnBlòk, Da Gama Canteen, Máximo and Papalo Taqueria; sixteen rooms are recommended (MR). Elliot Wood of Credence took the Service Award; Pappas Bros.' Steven McDonald the 2024 Sommelier Award.

James Beard 2026: Hugo Ortega and Tracy Vaught's H Town Restaurant Group (Hugo's, Xochi, Urbe, Caracol, Backstreet Café) were semifinalists for Outstanding Restaurateur. Past honors marked JBF: Benchawan Painter of Street to Kitchen won Best Chef: Texas in 2023; Himalaya's Kaiser Lashkari, Crawfish & Noodles' Trong Nguyen, Anvil's Bobby Heugel and Julep's Alba Huerta are repeat nominees; Hugo Ortega won Best Chef: Southwest in 2017. TM50 marks Texas Monthly's Top 50 BBQ list.

Occasion chips for Houston are editorial assignments, by category and price. Booking platforms are listed as best known at time of printing; the Resy app is the source of truth for the Amex credit. Crawfish season (February–June) and barbecue sell-out times are noted where they matter.

Photography via Pexels (royalty-free): three photographs — downtown from the freeway, the love-lock fence over the skyline, a barbecue awning — cropped and reused across the twelve sections.

Honestly Speaking — the masthead these guides are published under — is also an independent, unsponsored restaurant review site. The full reviews, with the plate-first criticism the city guides don't have room for, live at honestlyspeaking.xyz. The city guides live at listedeville.com.

For feedback — a question, a correction, a place we missed, or just to say hi — write to hello@listedeville.com.